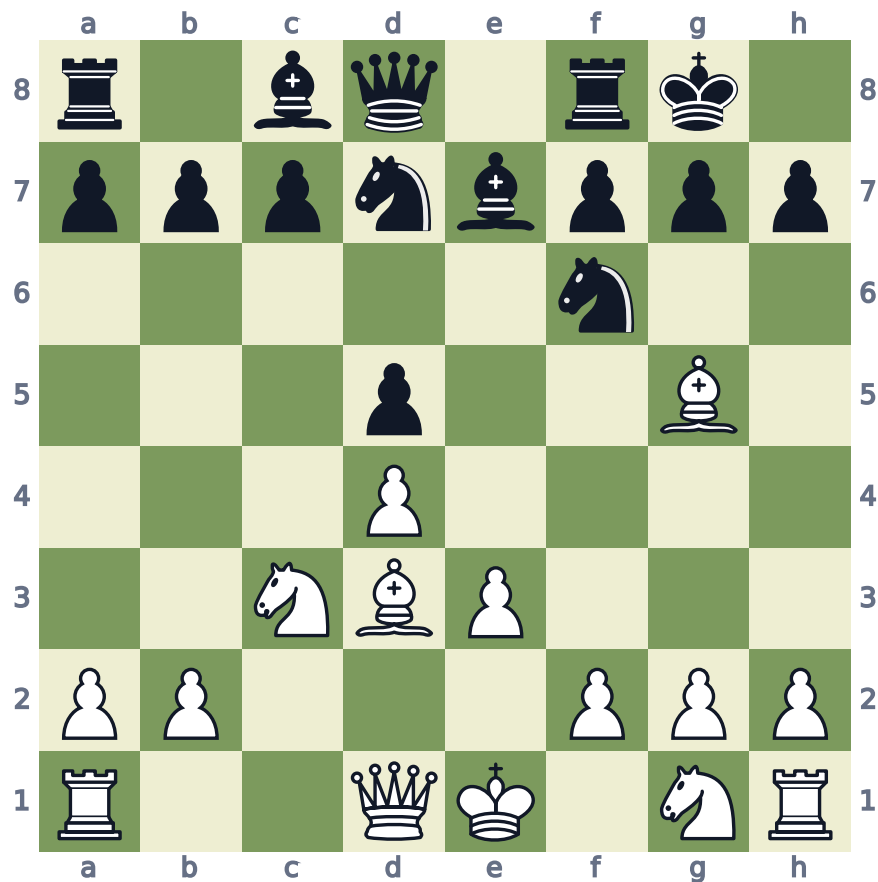


1.d4 Foundations and Repertoire Map

A coherent White repertoire based on d4, c4, Nf3, and sound central play



Understand the move-order map before memorizing branches, so every defense has a prepared destination and every move has a reason.

12 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Understand the move-order map before memorizing branches, so every defense has a prepared destination and every move has a reason.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 12 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Use 1.d4 to influence e5 and build a protected center.

PRINCIPLE 2

Play c4 against ...d5 to challenge Black's central anchor.

PRINCIPLE 3

Use Nf3 as the main move-order tool against Indian defenses.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Know when Nc3 is useful and when it permits the Nimzo-Indian.

PRINCIPLE 5

Choose pawn structures deliberately instead of drifting into them.

PRINCIPLE 6

Treat the repertoire as a decision tree, not a list of slogans.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Queen's Gambit map | ...d5 usually means c4; ...e6 often permits an Exchange QGD. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | Queen's Gambit Accepted map | Develop first; the pawn is rarely held safely. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | Slav map | ...c6 keeps the c8 bishop free; expect ...Bf5. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | Catalan map | Nf3 plus g3 against ...e6 and ...d5 points to the Catalan. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Queen's Indian map | ...b6 and ...Bb7 or ...Ba6 mean Black is fighting e4. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Bogo-Indian map | 3...Bb4+ asks where the c1 bishop or b1 knight will develop. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | King's Indian map | ...g6, ...Bg7, and ...d6 signal King's Indian intentions. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Grunfeld map | The immediate ...d5 after ...g6 is the Grunfeld challenge. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 9-12

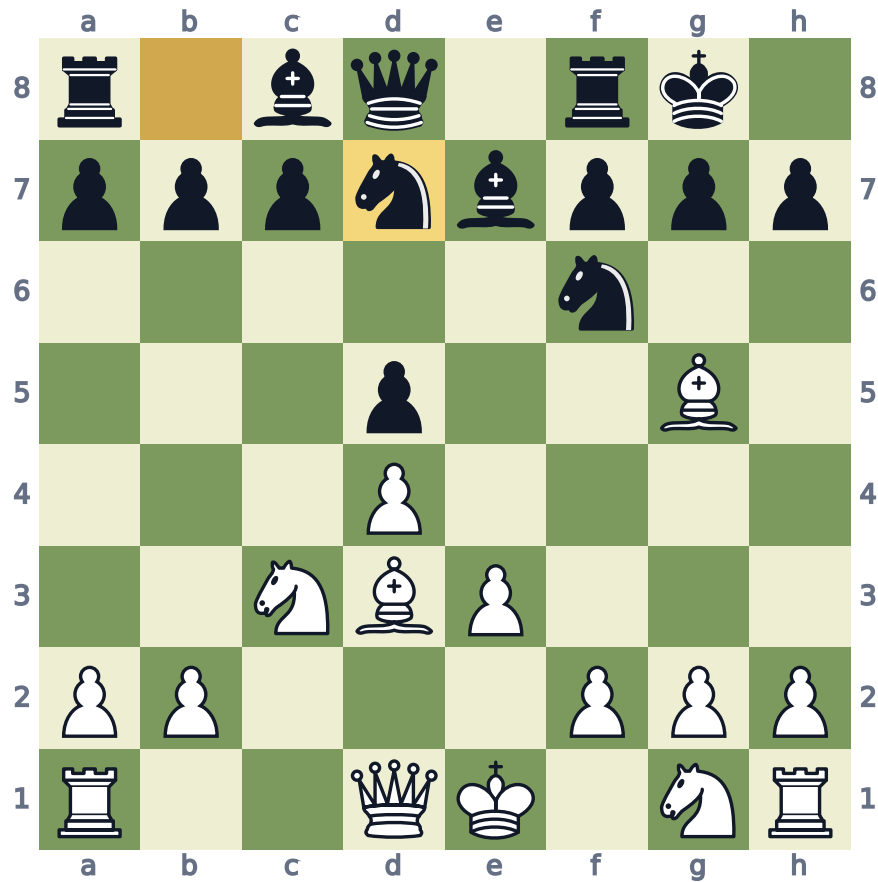
- | | | |
|-----------|--------------------------|--|
| 09 | Modern Benoni map | ...c5 followed by ...e6 and ...exd5 creates the Benoni structure. |
|
 | | |
| 10 | Benko map | ...b5 offers a pawn for the a- and b-files. |
|
 | | |
| 11 | Dutch map | ...f5 controls e4 but weakens Black's kingside. |
|
 | | |
| 12 | Rare-defense map | Against a surprise gambit, checks and development come before material counting. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Queen's Gambit map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Bg5 Be7 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd3 Nbd7

WHITE'S IDEA

Challenge d5, choose the Carlsbad structure, and complete development.

MAIN DANGER

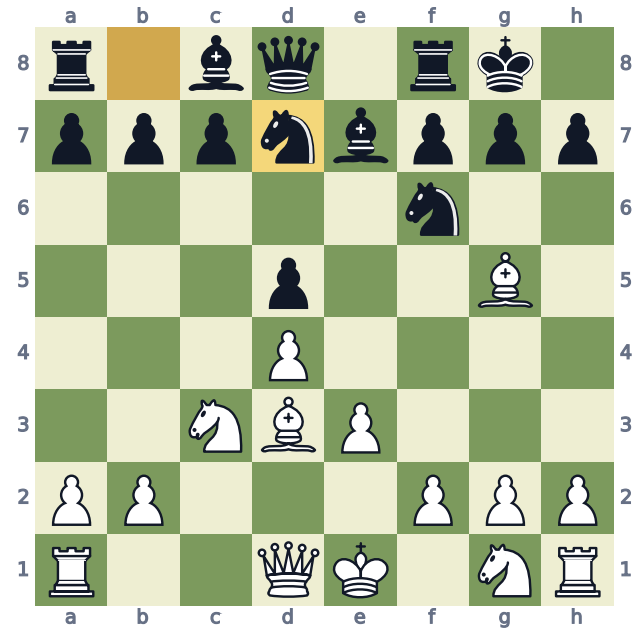
Do not assume the minority attack is automatic before development.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...d5 usually means c4; ...e6 often permits an Exchange QGD.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.41 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf3 c6 2. h3 Ne4 3. Bf4 Ndf6 4. O-O Re8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Queen's Gambit map



YOUR TASK

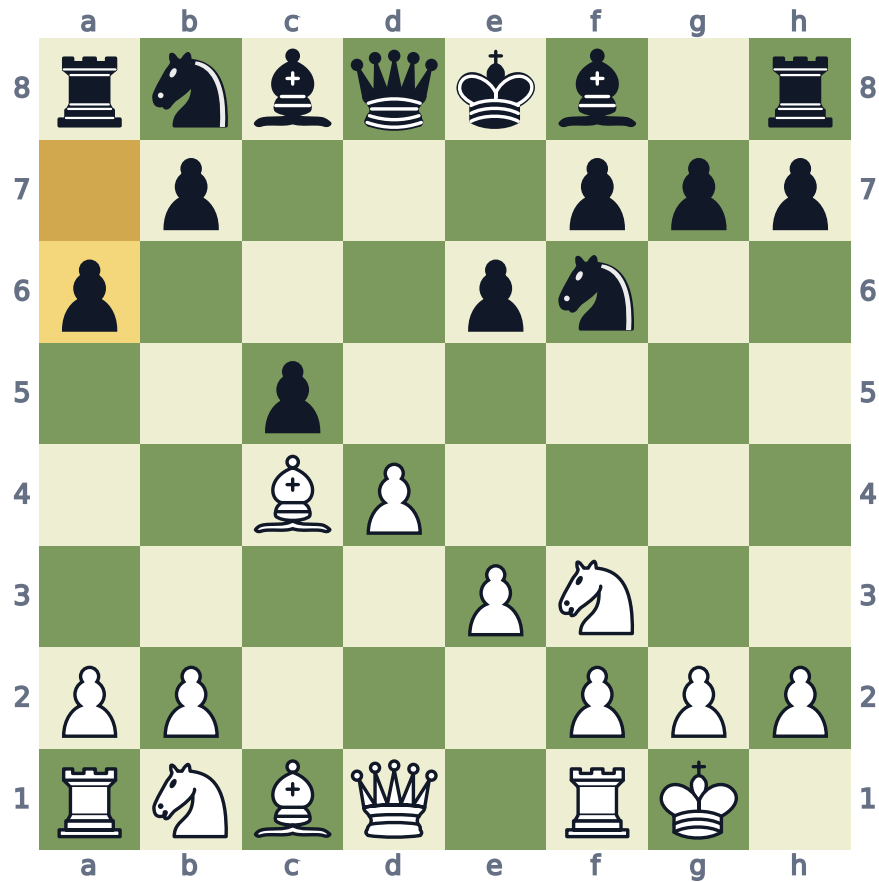
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Queen's Gambit Accepted map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6

WHITE'S IDEA

Recover c4 by developing and prepare a central or endgame decision.

MAIN DANGER

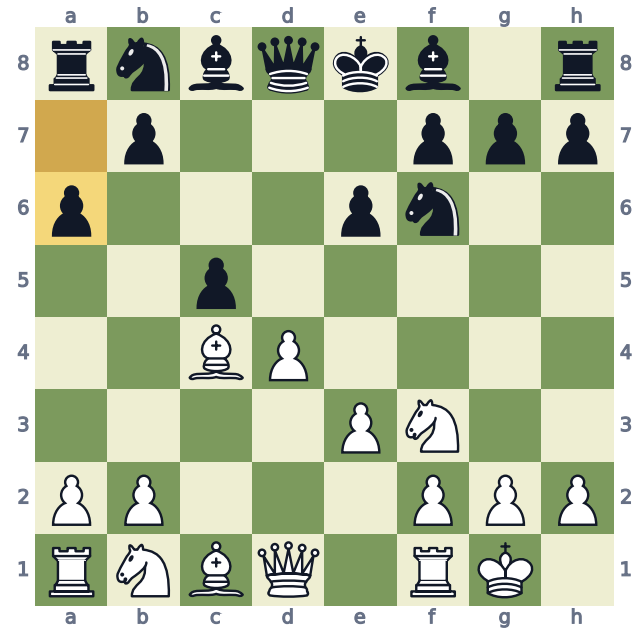
Chasing the pawn with Qa4+ or e3 too early can lose tempi.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Develop first; the pawn is rarely held safely.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.39 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. dxc5 Qxd1 2. Rxd1 Bxc5 3. Be2 O-O 4. b3 Bd7 5. Bb2 Bb5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Queen's Gambit Accepted map



YOUR TASK

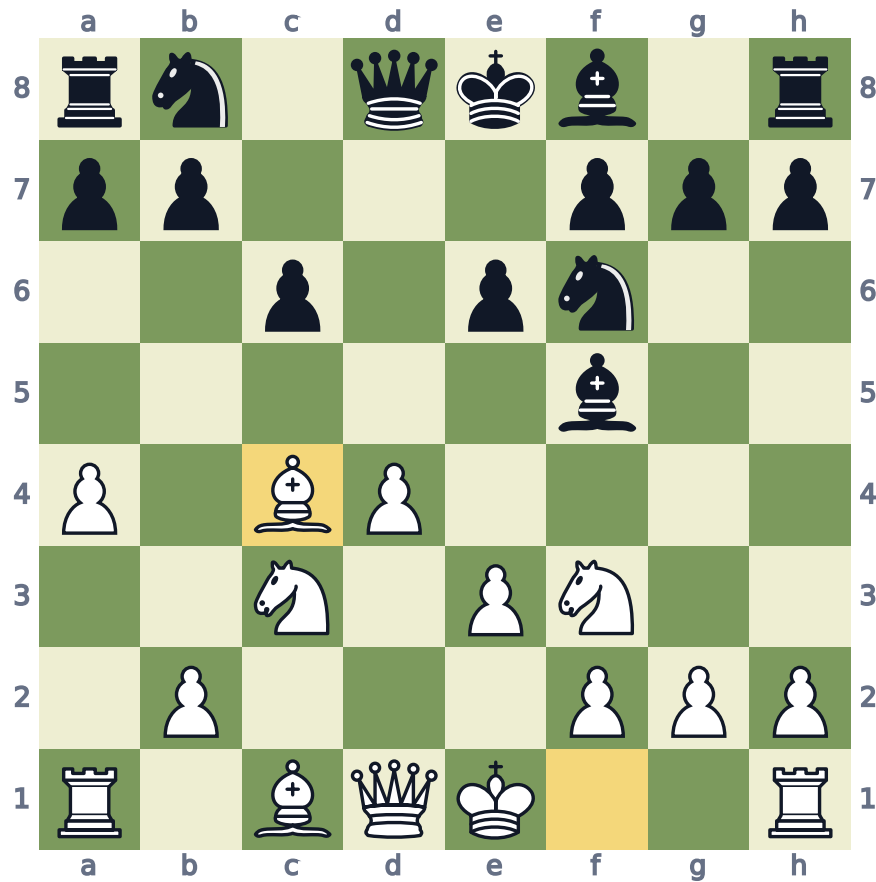
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Slav map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bf5 6. e3 e6 7. Bxc4

WHITE'S IDEA

Use a4 to limit ...b5 and recover c4 with development.

MAIN DANGER

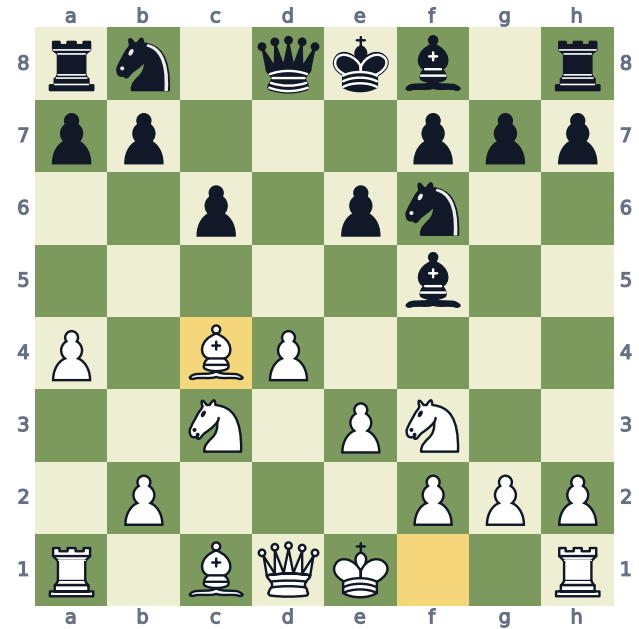
An unsupported e4 push can be hit by ...b5 and ...b4.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...c6 keeps the c8 bishop free; expect ...Bf5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.35 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nbd7 O-O 2. Bb4 Nh4 3. O-O Nxf5 4. exf5 Qb3 5. a5 Kh1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Slav map



YOUR TASK

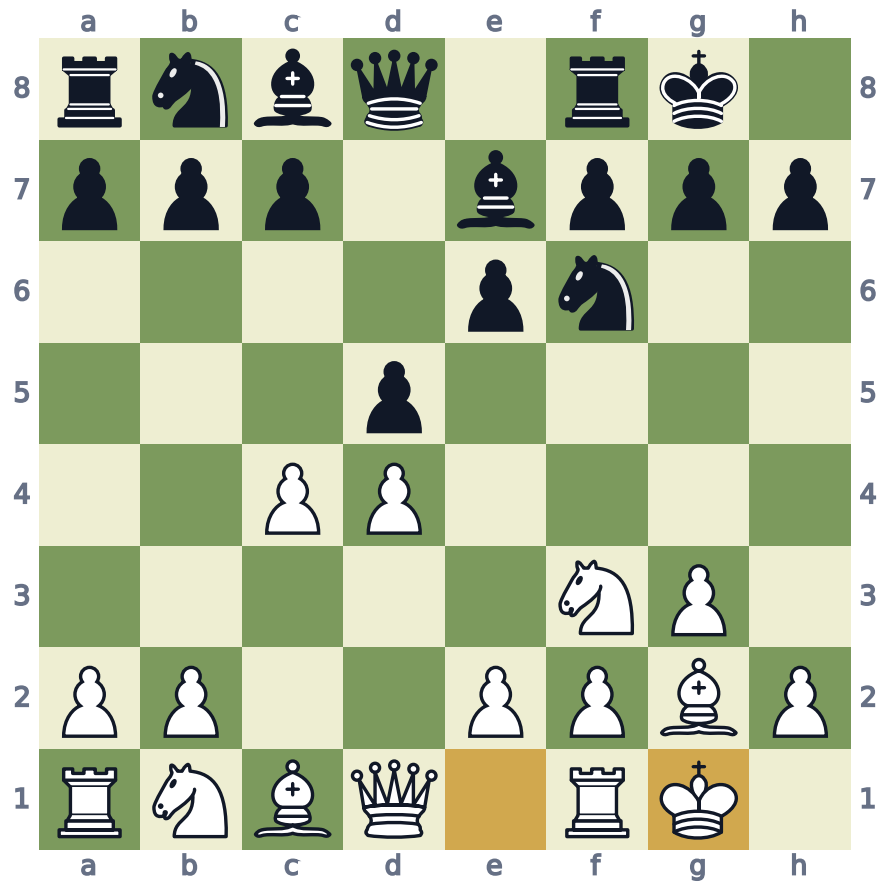
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Catalan map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

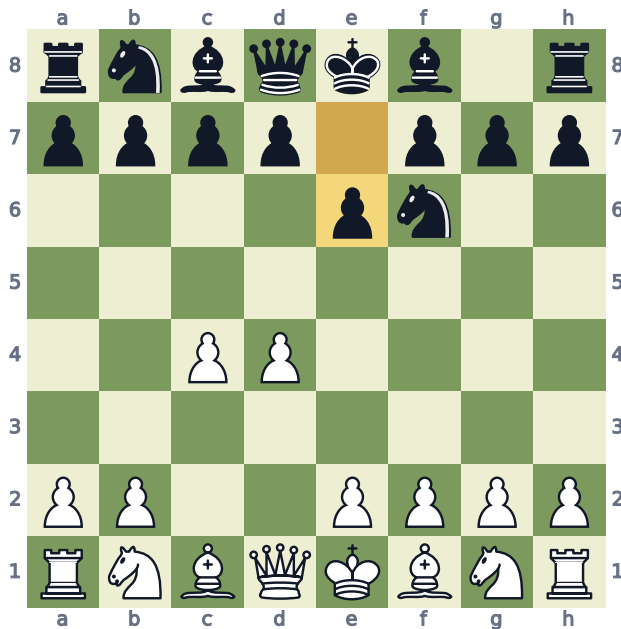
Fianchetto and pressure the queenside through the long diagonal.

MAIN DANGER

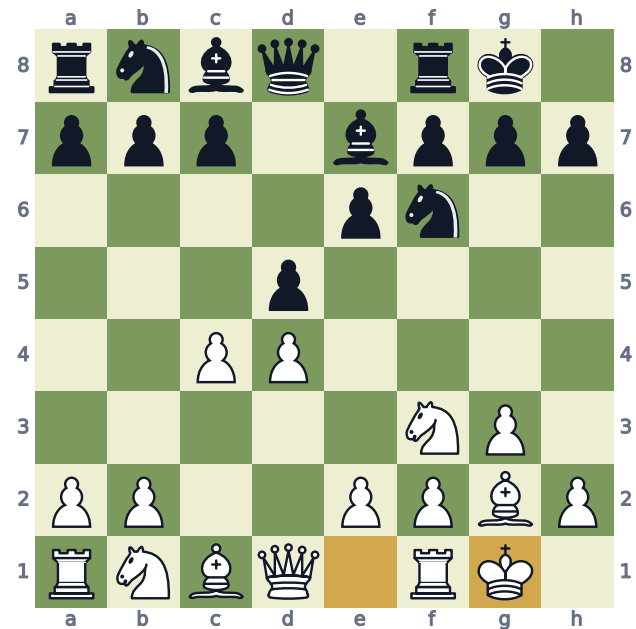
The bishop is ineffective if White never challenges the center.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Nf3 plus g3 against ...e6 and ...d5 points to the Catalan.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

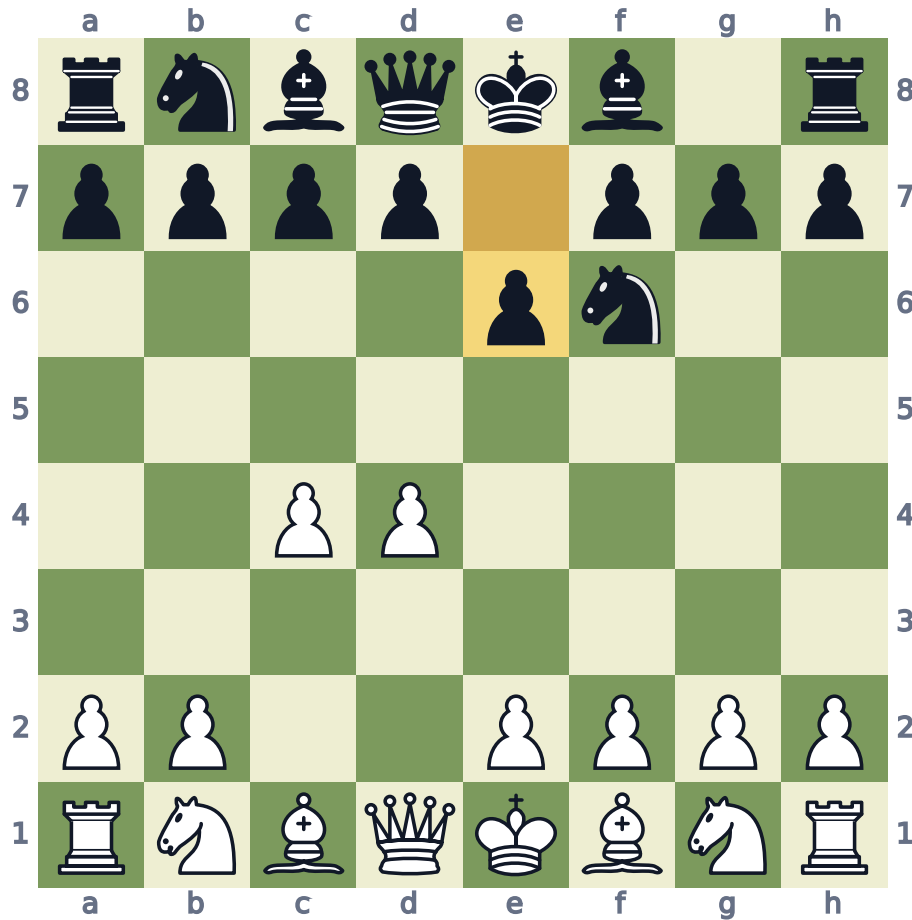
Position estimate: +0.48 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 Nc3 2. Nbd7 b3 3. Ne4 Nxe4 4. dxe4 Ne5 5. c5 Bxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Catalan map



YOUR TASK

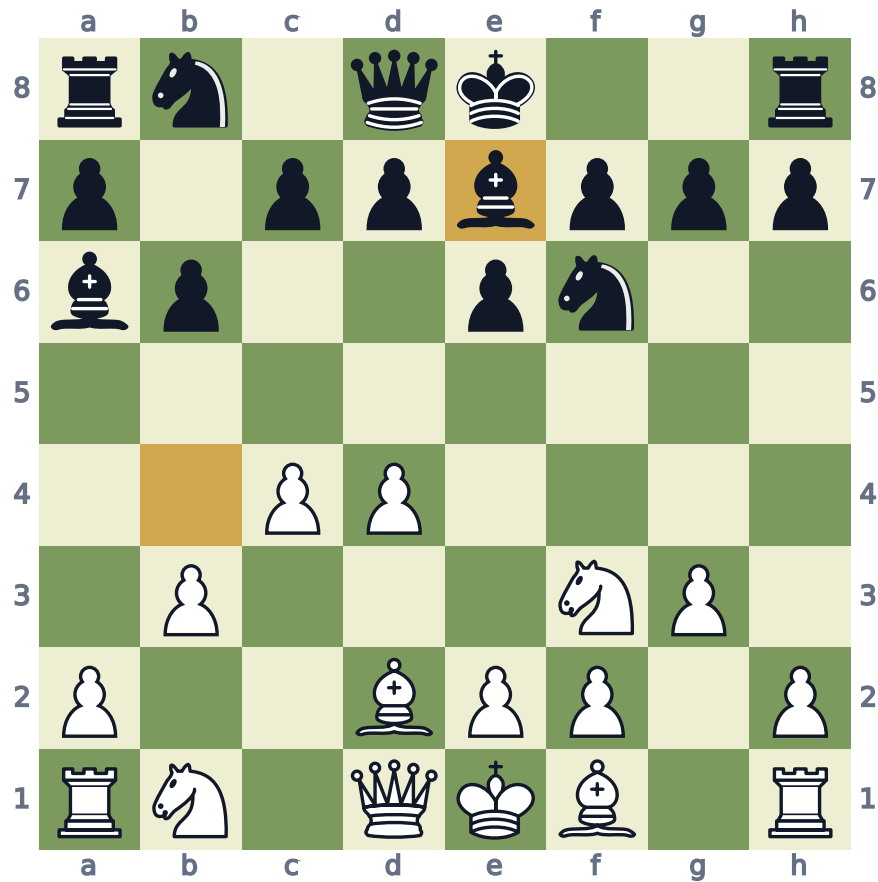
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Queen's Indian map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Be7

WHITE'S IDEA

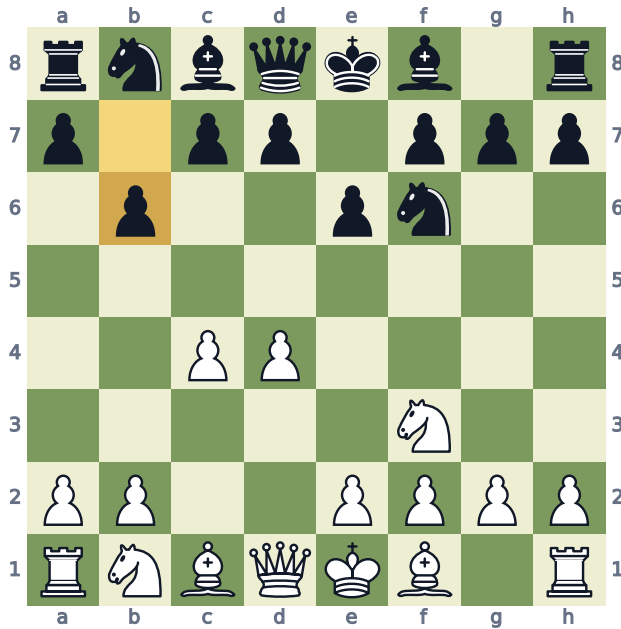
Meet e4-control with flexible fianchetto development.

MAIN DANGER

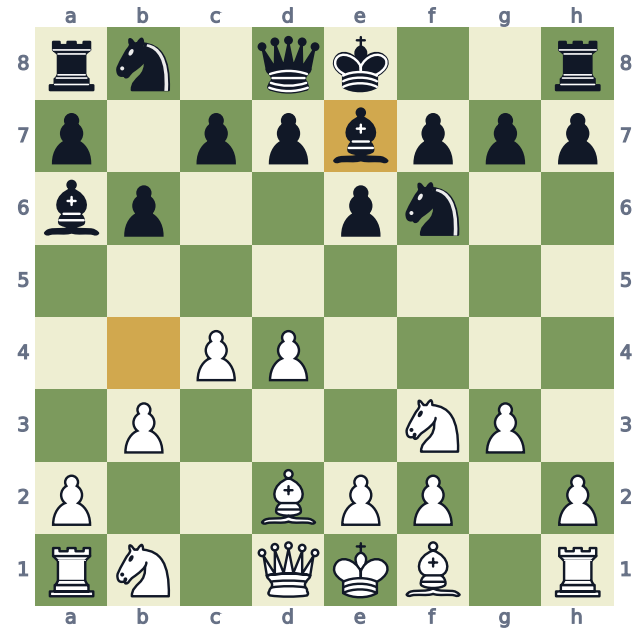
Playing e4 before completing development can lose the pawn.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...b6 and ...Bb7 or ...Ba6 mean Black is fighting e4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

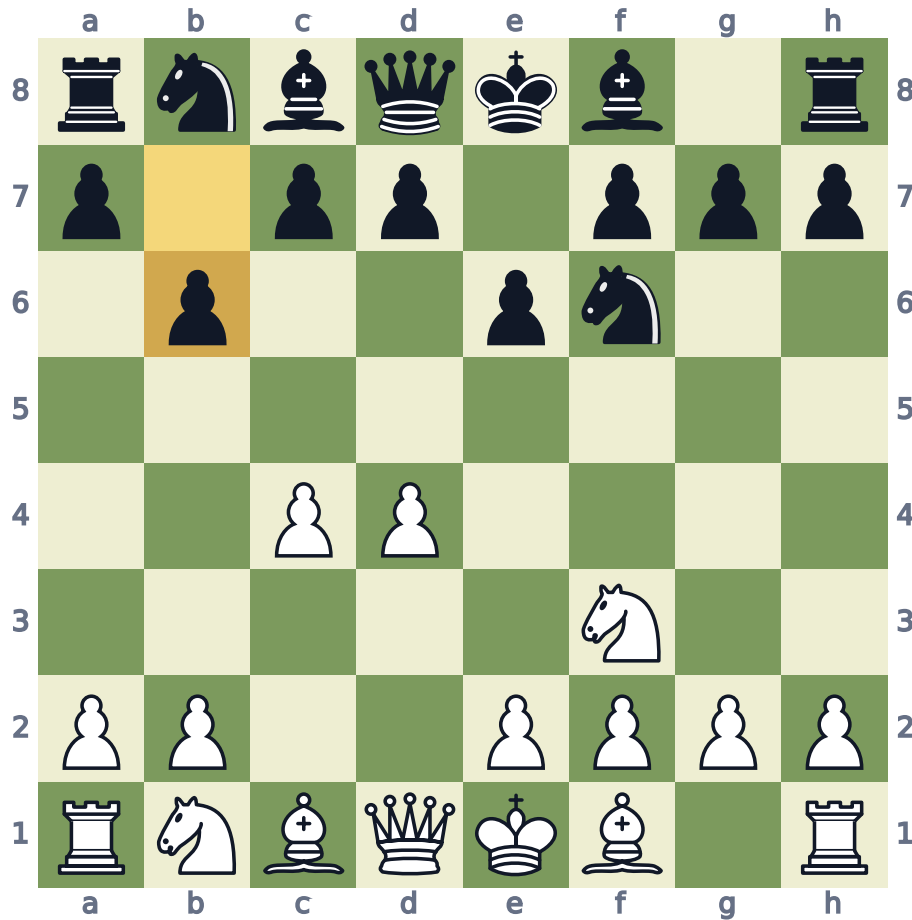
Position estimate: +0.46 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc3 d5 2. cxd5 exd5 3. Bg2 c6 4. O-O Nbd7 5. Re1 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Queen's Indian map



YOUR TASK

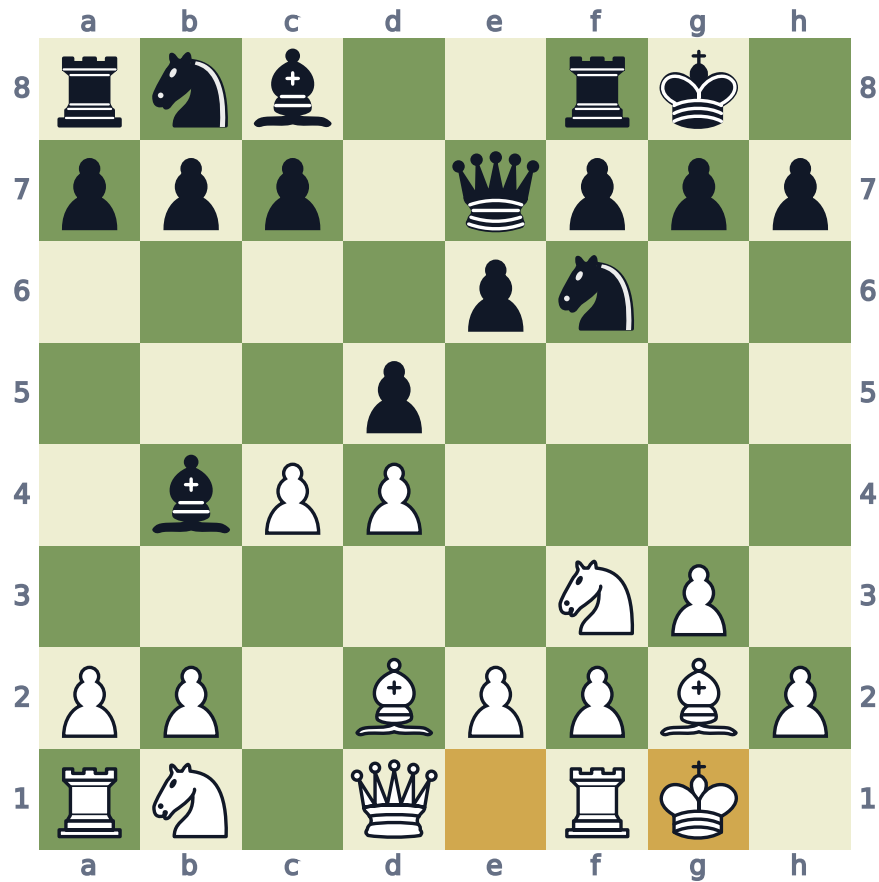
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Bogo-Indian map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Qe7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 d5 7. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Neutralize the check and transpose toward familiar Catalan structures.

MAIN DANGER

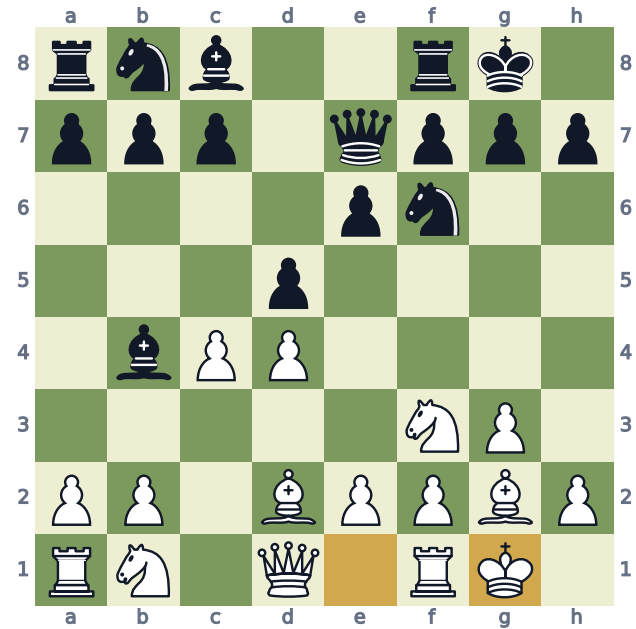
Do not concede awkward piece placement without a reason.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

3...Bb4+ asks where the c1 bishop or b1 knight will develop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

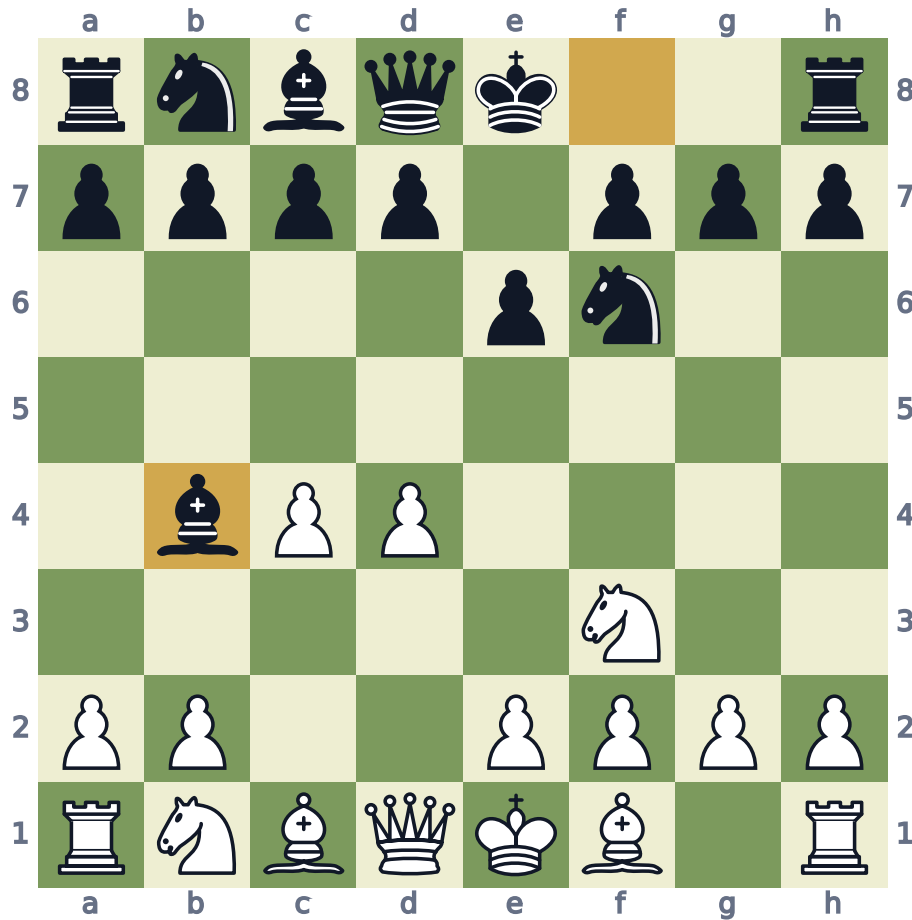
Position estimate: +0.59 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nbd7 Qc2 2. Bxd2 Nbx d2 3. c5 Rfe1 4. b6 dxc5 5. bxc5 e4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Bogo-Indian map



YOUR TASK

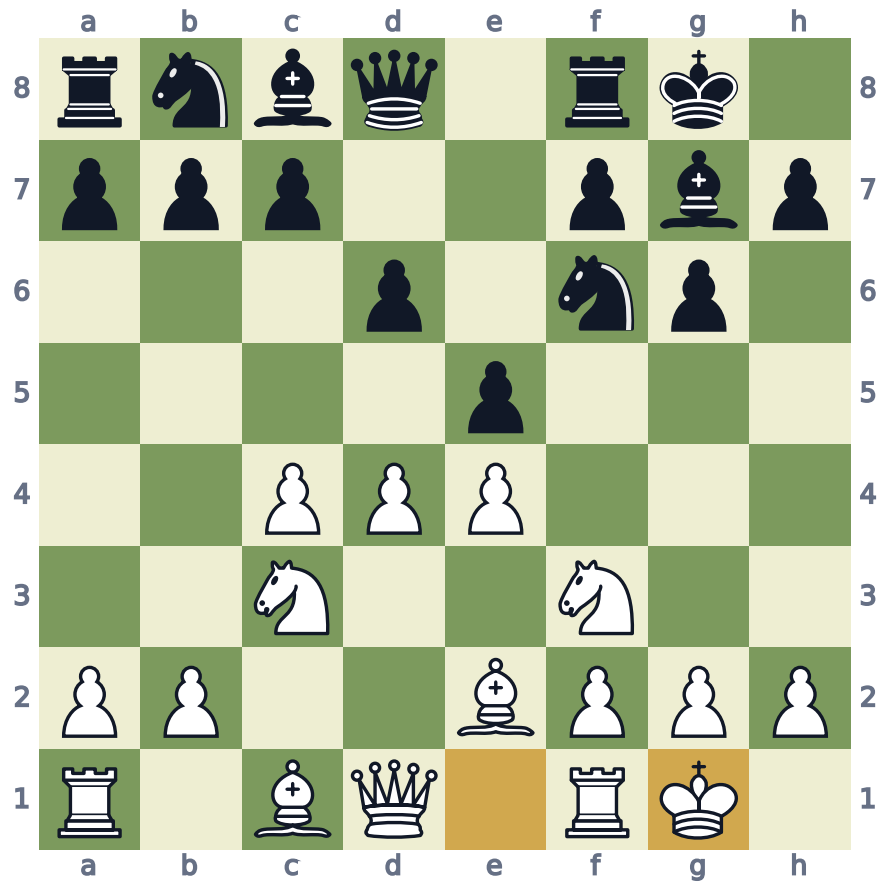
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

King's Indian map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

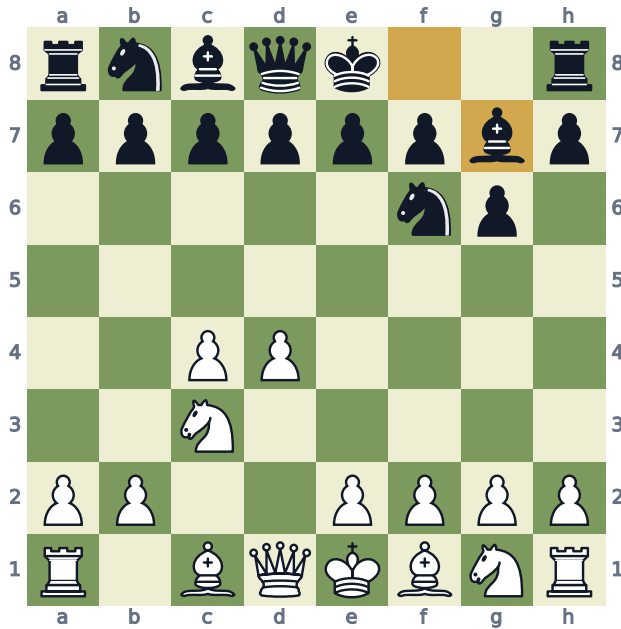
Build the center, castle, and then decide whether to close with d5.

MAIN DANGER

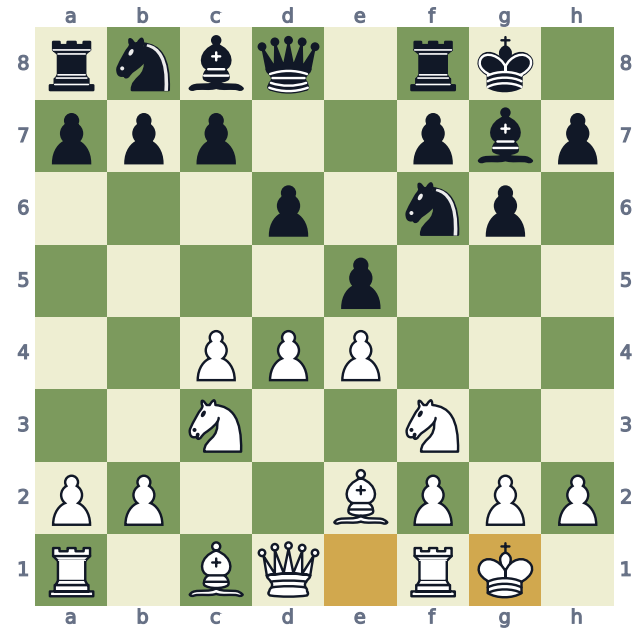
A closed center starts a race; ignoring ...f5 is dangerous.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...g6, ...Bg7, and ...d6 signal King's Indian intentions.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

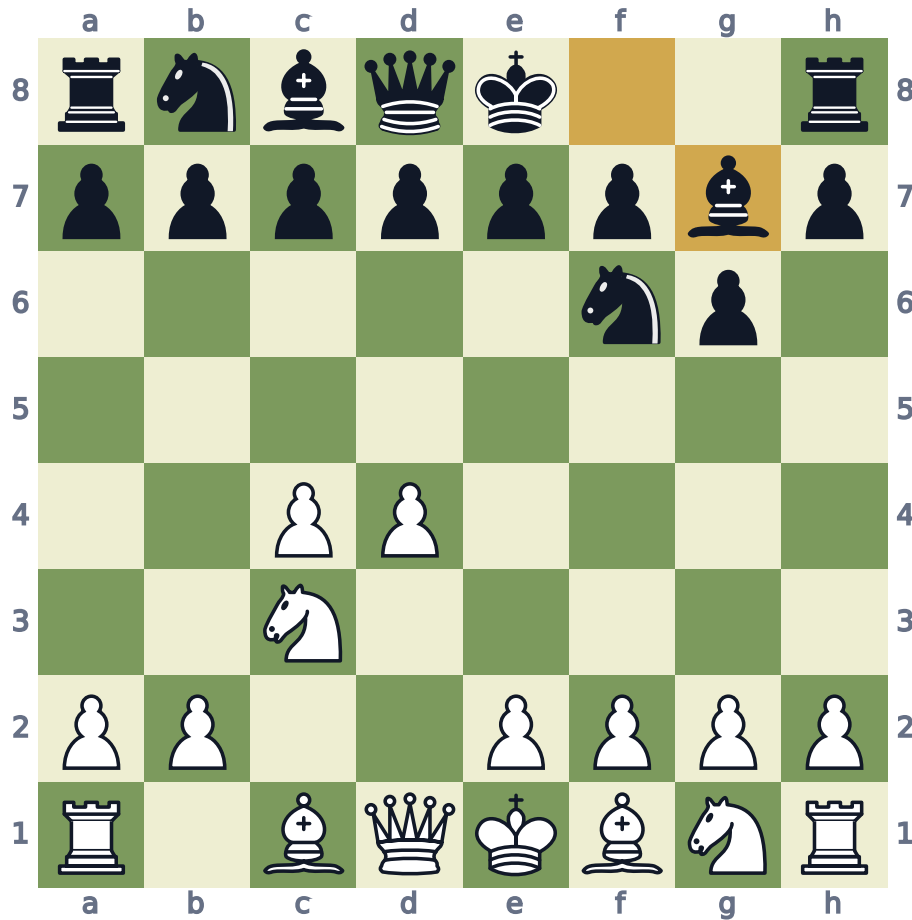
Position estimate: +0.56 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. exd4 Nxd4 2. Re8 f3 3. Nh5 Be3 4. Nc6 Nxc6 5. bxc6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

King's Indian map



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Grunfeld map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 d5 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. e4 Nxc3 6. bxc3 Bg7

WHITE'S IDEA

Use the center while supporting its base and finishing development.

MAIN DANGER

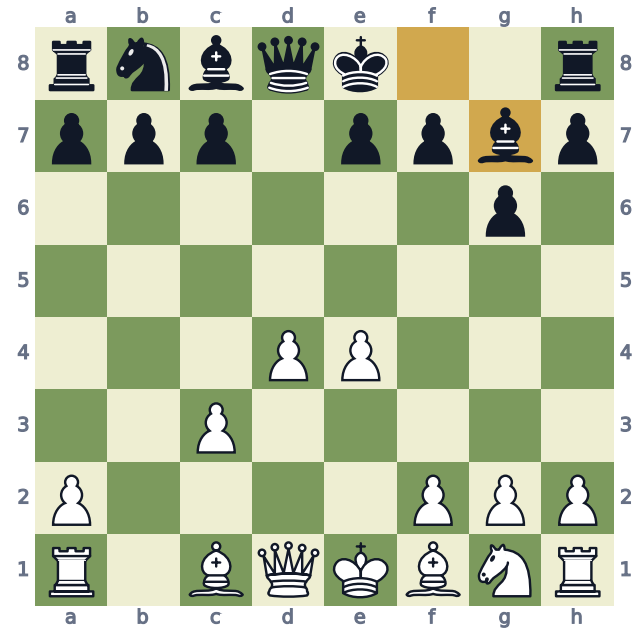
A broad center can become an overextended target.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The immediate ...d5 after ...g6 is the Grunfeld challenge.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

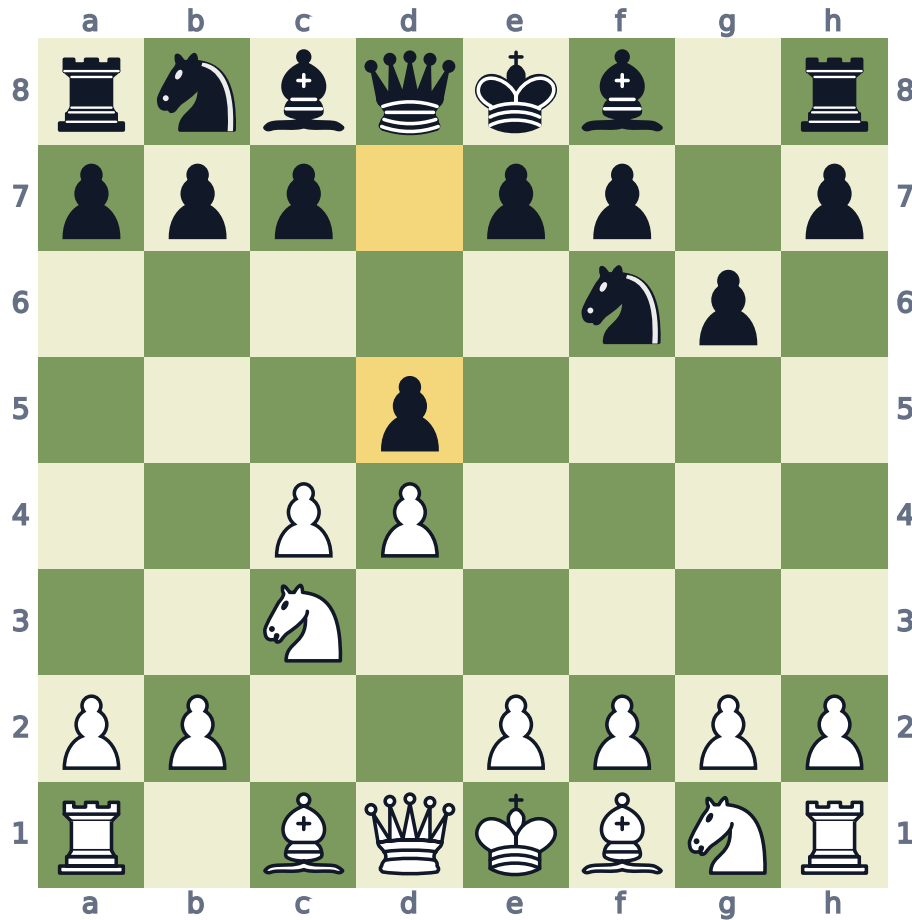
Position estimate: +0.45 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qa4+ Qd7 2. Qa3 b6 3. Nf3 c5 4. Bd3 O-O 5. O-O Qc7

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Grunfeld map



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 09

Modern Benoni map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6

WHITE'S IDEA

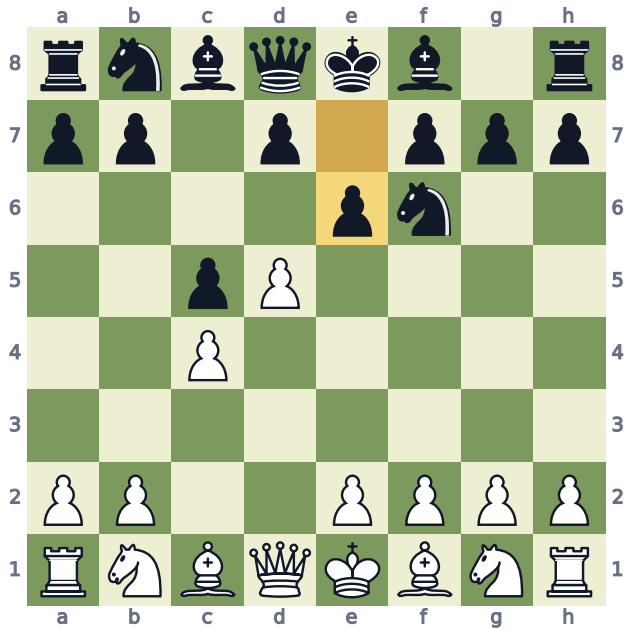
Use space and prepare e5 or f4 while Black seeks ...b5.

MAIN DANGER

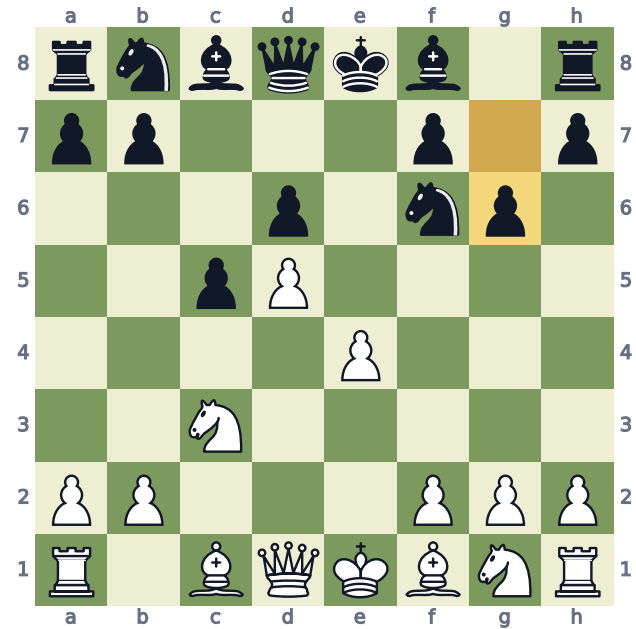
Slow play lets Black create queenside counterplay for free.

BRANCH LOGIC 09

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...c5 followed by ...e6 and ...exd5 creates the Benoni structure.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

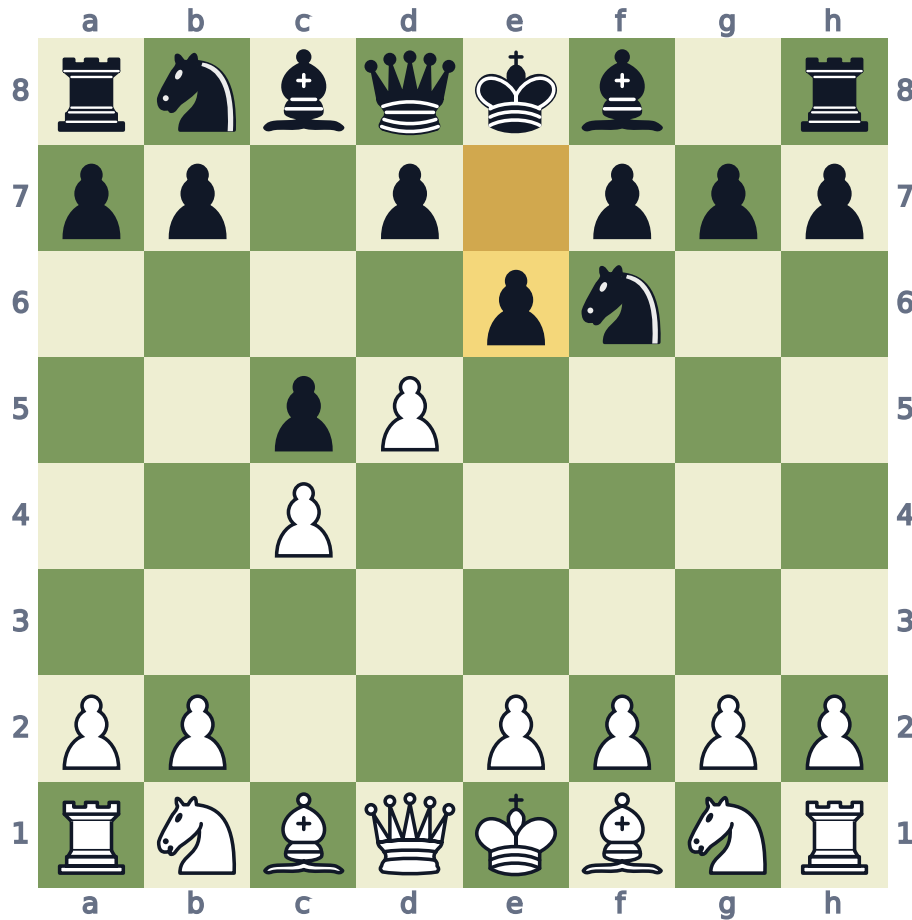
Position estimate: +0.92 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. h3 Bg7 2. Bd3 Na6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 09

Modern Benoni map



YOUR TASK

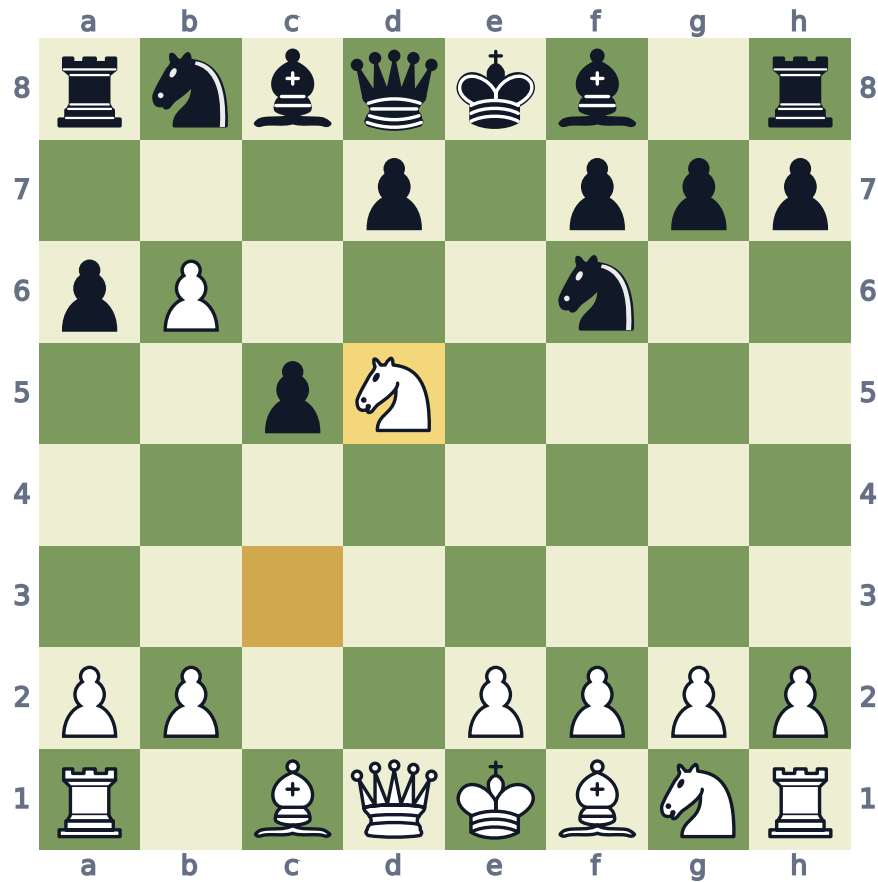
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 10

Benko map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. b6 e6 6. Nc3 exd5 7. Nxd5

WHITE'S IDEA

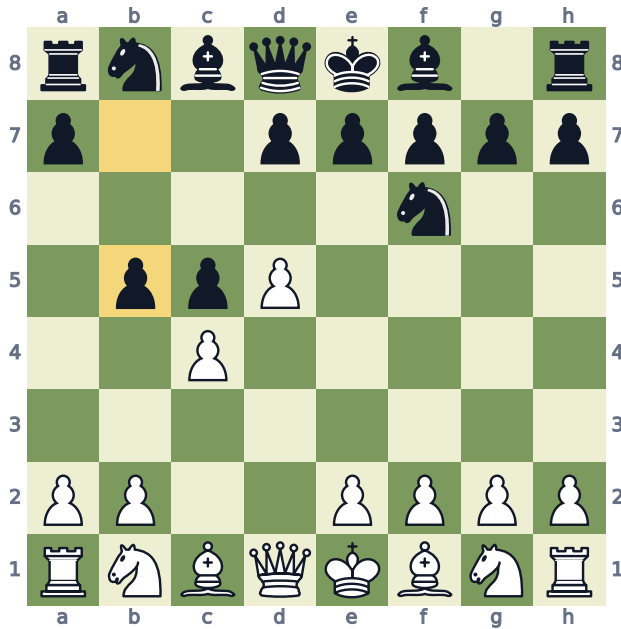
Decline full queenside exposure with b6 and retain a stable extra space advantage.

MAIN DANGER

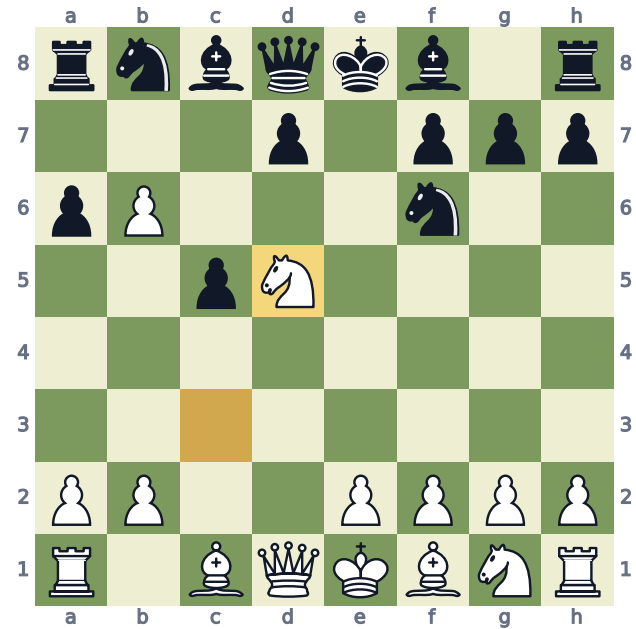
Keeping every pawn can invite lasting file pressure.

BRANCH LOGIC 10

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...b5 offers a pawn for the a- and b-files.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

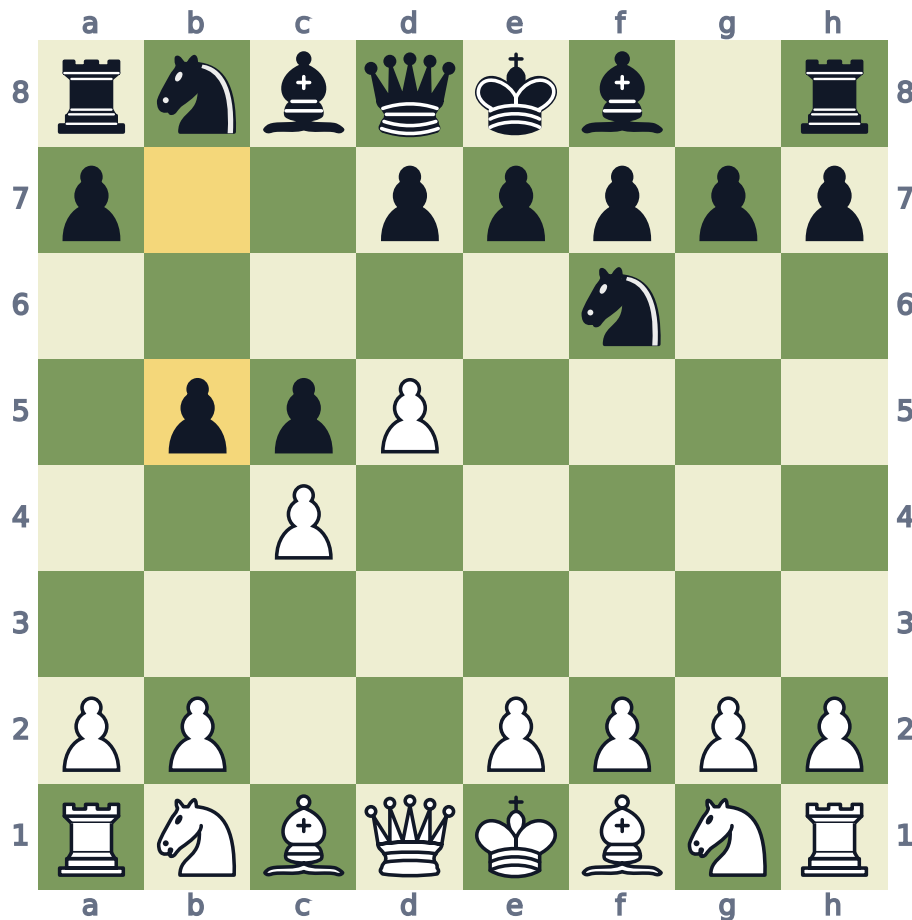
Position estimate: +0.14 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. Nxd5 Qxd5 2. Nc6 Nf3 3. Be7 e3 4. Rb8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 10

Benko map



YOUR TASK

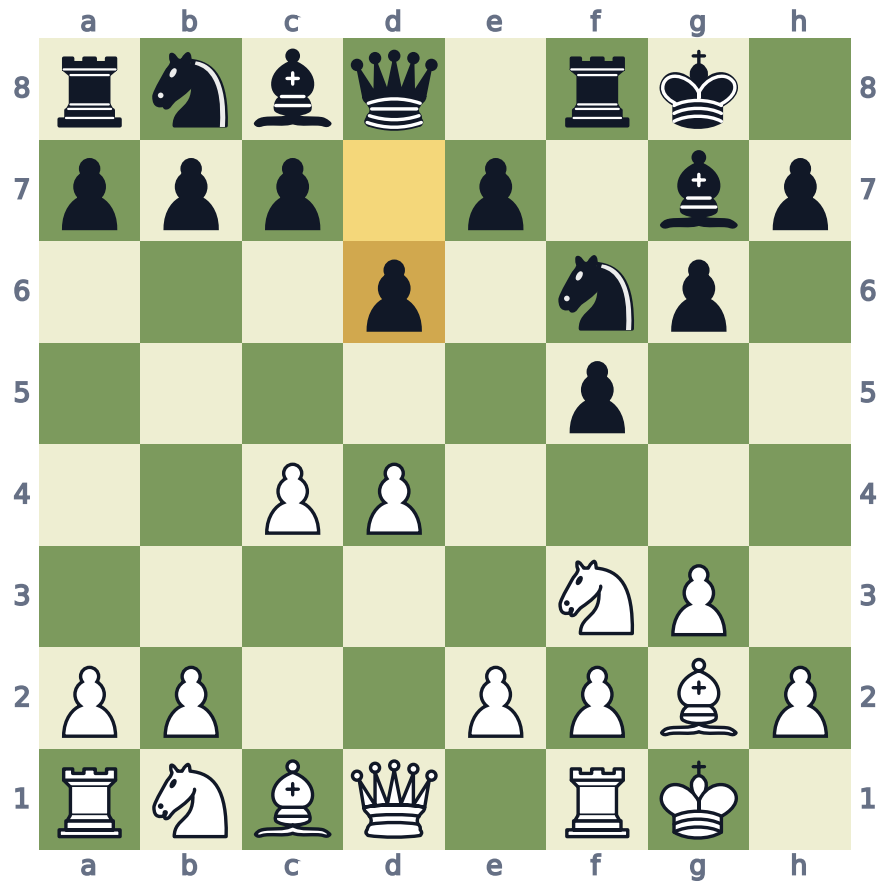
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 11

Dutch map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. O-O O-O 6. c4 d6

WHITE'S IDEA

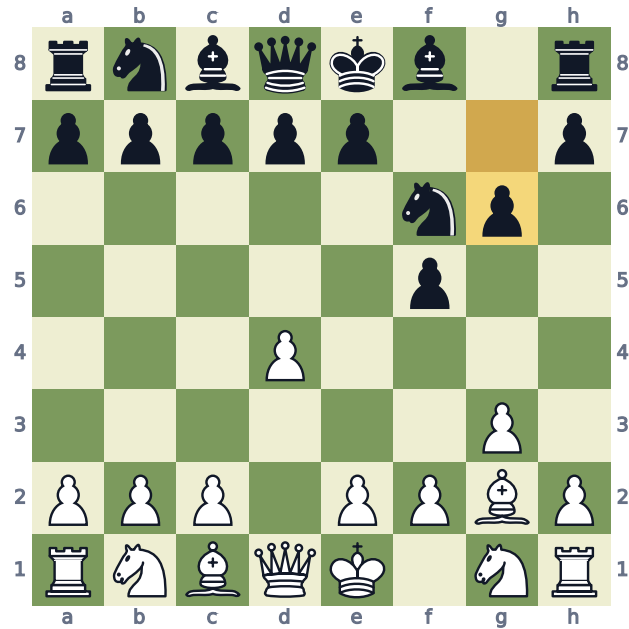
Fianchetto, castle, and challenge the dark-square setup calmly.

MAIN DANGER

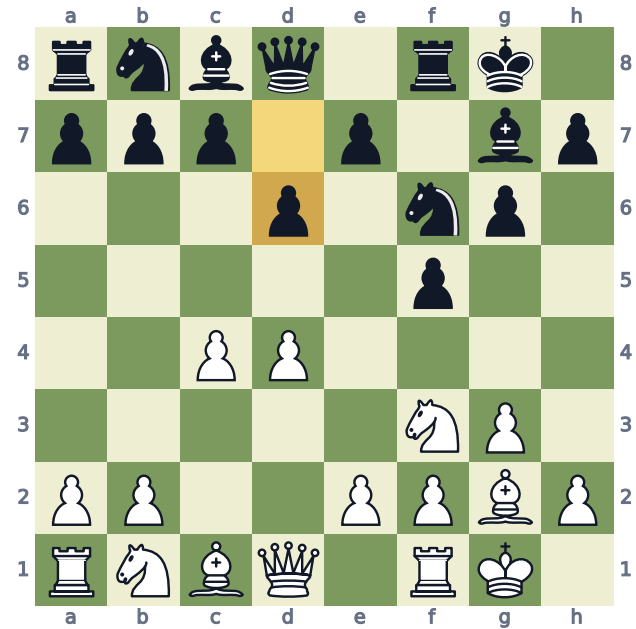
Immediate king attacks are premature while the center is fluid.

BRANCH LOGIC 11

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...f5 controls e4 but weakens Black's kingside.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

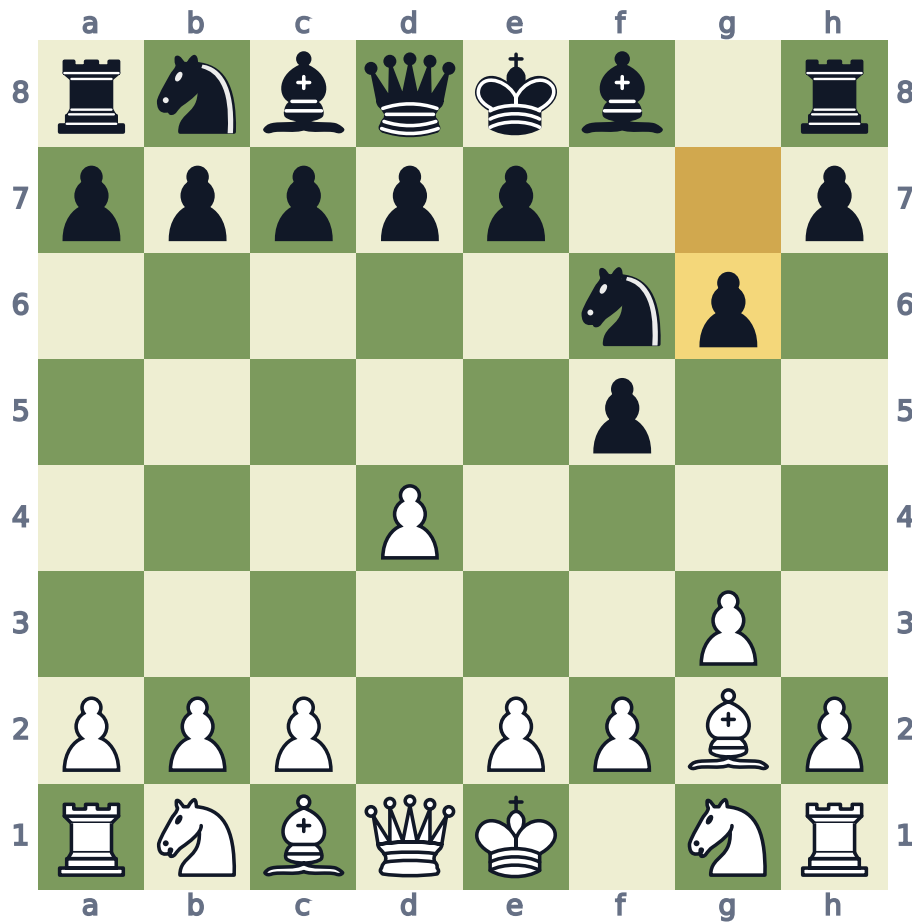
Position estimate: +0.67 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc3 c6 2. d5 cxd5 3. Nxd5 Nc6 4. Nxf6+ Bxf6 5. Bh6 Re8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 11

Dutch map



YOUR TASK

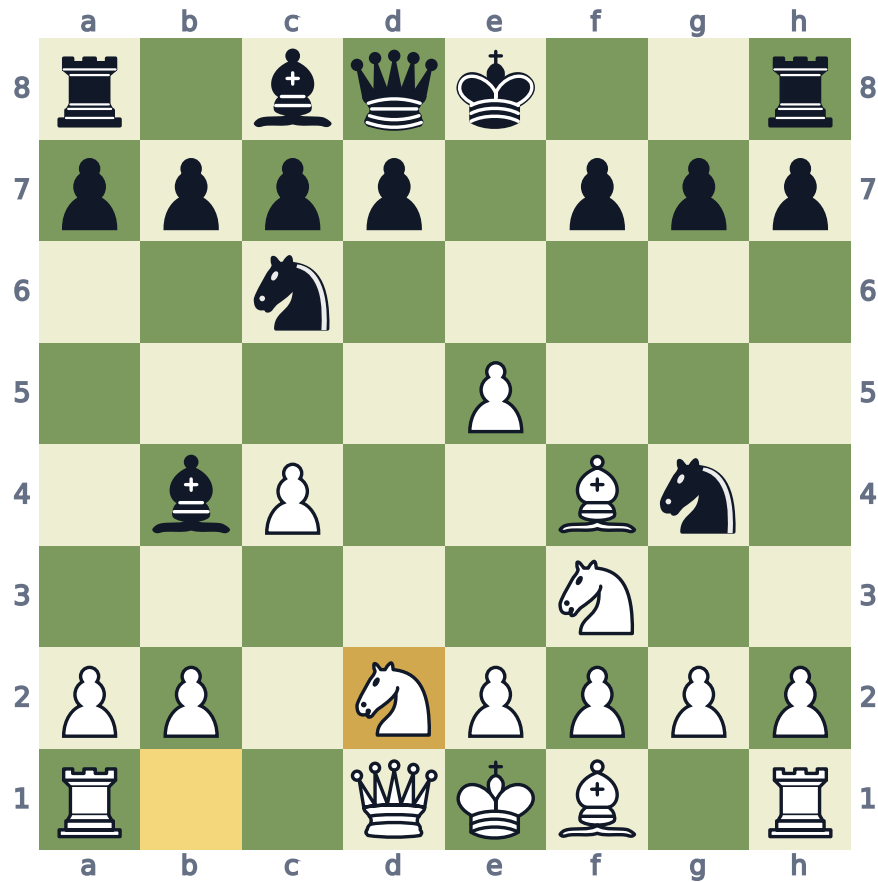
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 12

Rare-defense map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 Ng4 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bf4 Bb4+ 6. Nbd2

WHITE'S IDEA

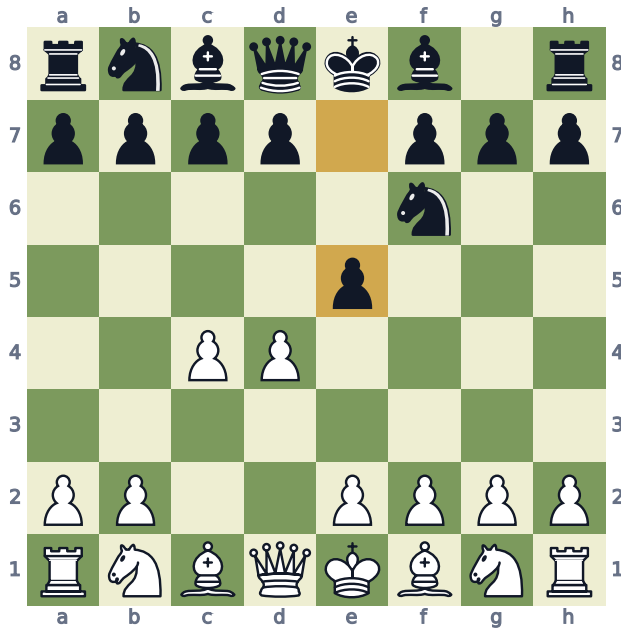
Accept the Budapest pawn, develop, and return it if necessary to keep coordination.

MAIN DANGER

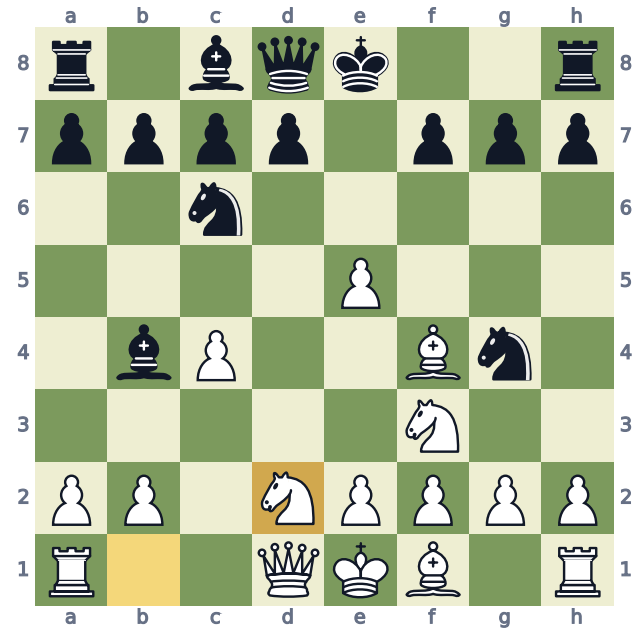
Greed and neglect of checks are the main dangers.

BRANCH LOGIC 12

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against a surprise gambit, checks and development come before material counting.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

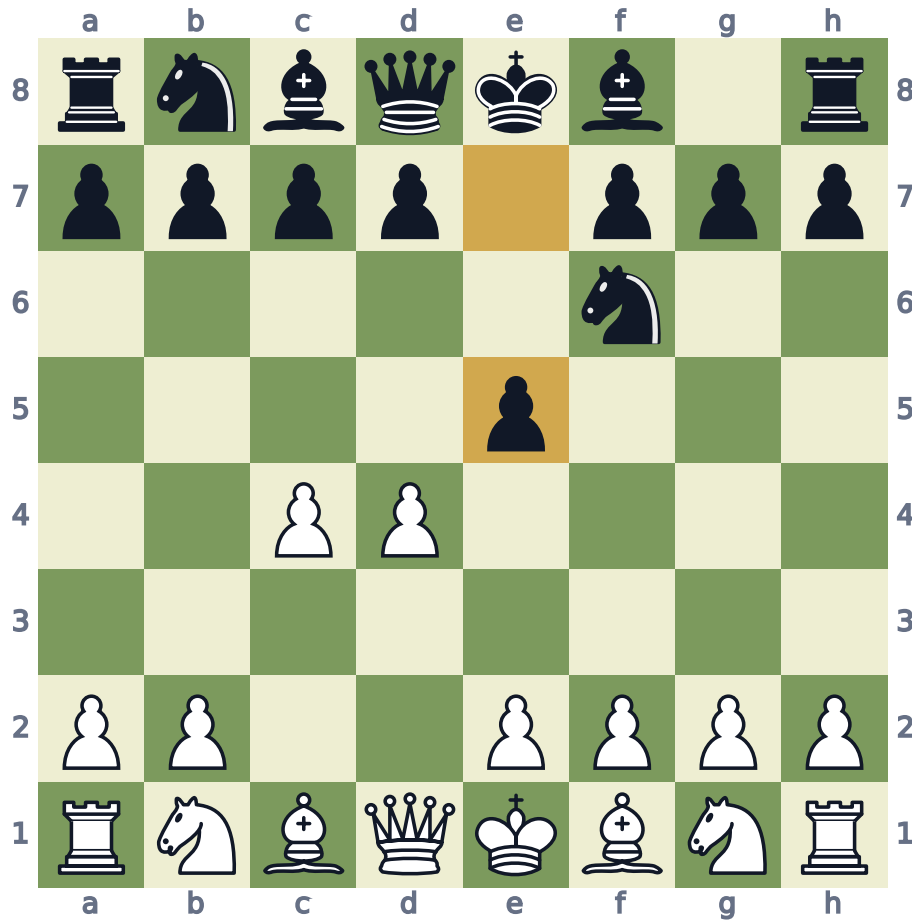
Position estimate: +0.57 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qe7 a3 2. Bxd2+ Qxd2 3. Ngxe5 Nxe5 4. Nxe5 Qe3 5. d6 c5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 12

Rare-defense map



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. QUEEN'S GAMBIT MAP

Course move: cxd5. Purpose: Challenge d5, choose the Carlsbad structure, and complete development. Engine comparison: 1. Bg5 dxc4 2. e4 c5 3. d5 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Do not assume the minority attack is automatic before development.

02. QUEEN'S GAMBIT ACCEPTED MAP

Course move: e3. Purpose: Recover c4 by developing and prepare a central or endgame decision. Engine comparison: 1. e3 c5 2. Bxc4 e6 3. O-O a6 4. dxc5 Qxd1 5. Rxd1 Bxc5 (+0.39 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Chasing the pawn with Qa4+ or e3 too early can lose tempi.

03. SLAV MAP

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use a4 to limit ...b5 and recover c4 with development. Engine comparison: 1. e3 e6 2. Bd3 dxc4 3. Bxc4 c5 4. O-O a6 5. dxc5 Bxc5 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: An unsupported e4 push can be hit by ...b5 and ...b4.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. CATALAN MAP

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Fianchetto and pressure the queenside through the long diagonal. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 c5 4. dxc5 Bxc5 5. Bg2 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The bishop is ineffective if White never challenges the center.

05. QUEEN'S INDIAN MAP

Course move: g3. Purpose: Meet e4-control with flexible fianchetto development. Engine comparison: 1. a3 Bb7 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bg5 Be7 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. Bxe7 Qxe7 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Playing e4 before completing development can lose the pawn.

06. BOGO-INDIAN MAP

Course move: Bd2. Purpose: Neutralize the check and transpose toward familiar Catalan structures. Engine comparison: 1. Nbd2 O-O 2. a3 Bxd2+ 3. Bxd2 b6 4. e3 Ne4 5. Bd3 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Do not concede awkward piece placement without a reason.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-9

07. KING'S INDIAN MAP

Course move: e4. Purpose: Build the center, castle, and then decide whether to close with d5. Engine comparison: 1. e4 O-O 2. Be2 d6 3. h4 h5 4. f3 Nc6 5. Be3 e5 (+0.62 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A closed center starts a race; ignoring ...f5 is dangerous.

08. GRUNFELD MAP

Course move: cxd5. Purpose: Use the center while supporting its base and finishing development. Engine comparison: 1. Qb3 c6 2. cxd5 cxd5 3. Bf4 Nc6 4. e3 a6 5. Nf3 (+0.48 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A broad center can become an overextended target.

09. MODERN BENONI MAP

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use space and prepare e5 or f4 while Black seeks ...b5. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 g6 2. e4 d6 3. h3 Bg7 4. Bd3 (+0.95 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: Slow play lets Black create queenside counterplay for free.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 10-12

10. BENKO MAP

Course move: cxb5. Purpose: Decline full queenside exposure with b6 and retain a stable extra space advantage. Engine comparison: 1. cxb5 a6 2. bxa6 e6 3. Nc3 exd5 4. Nxd5 Be7 5. Nf3 Nxd5 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Keeping every pawn can invite lasting file pressure.

11. DUTCH MAP

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Fianchetto, castle, and challenge the dark-square setup calmly. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 c6 2. c4 Bg7 3. O-O O-O (+0.71 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Immediate king attacks are premature while the center is fluid.

12. RARE-DEFENSE MAP

Course move: dxe5. Purpose: Accept the Budapest pawn, develop, and return it if necessary to keep coordination. Engine comparison: 1. dxe5 Ng4 2. e4 Bb4+ 3. Bd2 Bxd2+ 4. Qxd2 Nxe5 (+0.75 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Greed and neglect of checks are the main dangers.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.